

AIGC Threat Taxonomy and Evolution Ladder

EVOLUTION LADDER

EVOLUTION LEVEL

THREAT VECTORS

1 Direct PI

2022

Low

Goal hijacking

Prompt leaking

Instruction override

Access: Direct input | Agency: Passive output | Scope: Single output

2 Jailbreaking

2023

Low

Template-based (DAN)

Optimization (GCG, PAIR)

Multi-turn (Crescendo)

Multi-modal (FigStep)

Encoding-based (cipher)

Access: Crafted input | Agency: Active instruction following | Scope: Session state

3 Indirect PI

2023

Very low

RAG poisoning

Web content injection

Email/doc injection

Data exfiltration

Access: Third-party content | Agency: Retrieval + execution | Scope: Persistent state

4 Agentic Exploitation

2024

Very low

Tool poisoning (72.8%)

Cross-server composition

MCP supply chain

IDE vulnerabilities

Access: Tool chains, MCP servers | Agency: Autonomous multi-step | Scope: Cross-system cascade

5 Multi-Agent (Emerging)

2025

None

Inter-agent trust (82.4%)

Memory poisoning

Privilege escalation

Access: Inter-agent messages | Agency: Delegated autonomy | Scope: Cross-org cascade